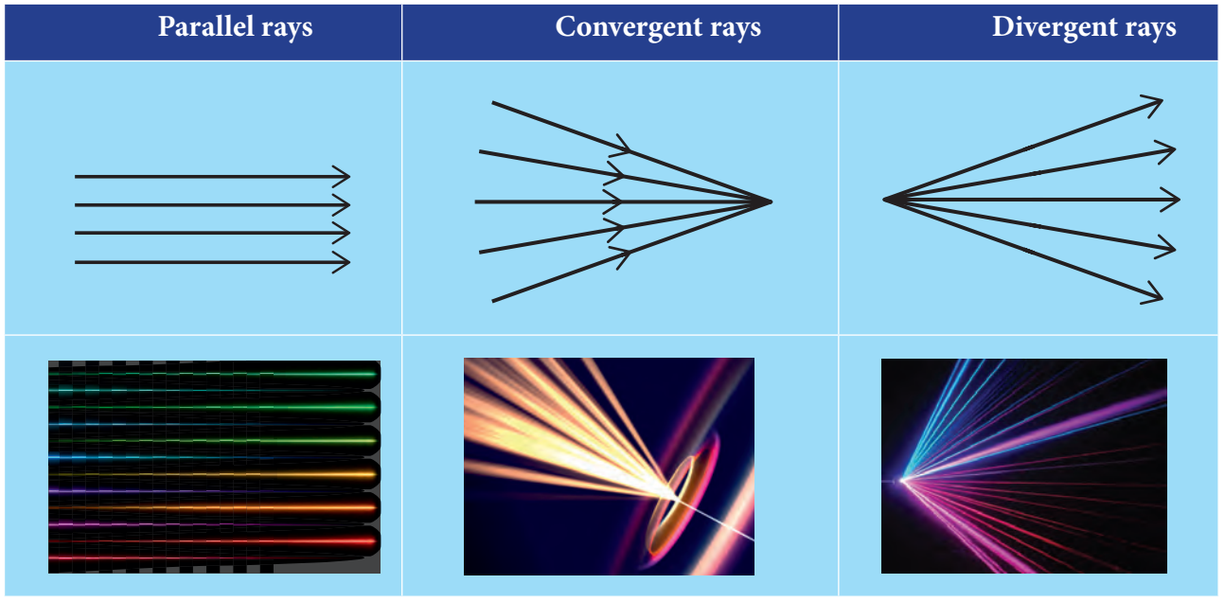


were smooth mirror like. Then sunlight entering through the window will get bounced by the floor at an angle above towards the roof. And it will never get reflected to left or right. That is left and right walls will remain dark. However walls and floors are not smooth surfaces. Therefore, incident light from the window get bounced in all directions that the whole room is illuminated with diffused light.

Types of beam of light

Generally light is not a single ray, but a bundle of rays which are called as a beam of light.

A light beam can be a bundle of parallel rays, convergent rays or divergent rays. Let us look at the light coming from the Sun. The rays of sunlight are parallel. Often the headlight of car gives parallel rays. However look at the rays of light coming out of a candle. Light rays go in all directions, from the candle fire. These rays are divergent. Light rays from a flash light is also divergent. Using lenses we can converge light rays. Using a lens, you can focus sunlight at a point. That is what we are making the light rays to converge.

Speed of light:

When lighting a bulb in a dark room, light spreads the whole room quickly. This is because the light travels very fast. Light travels three lakh kilometers per second in air or vacuum. In theory , nothing can travel faster than light

Interaction of light with matter

Take a piece of clear glass, a paper and a metal sheet. Shine a light from one side of each object and see if the light penetrate on the other side. Readily, we can see light enters and comes out of the other end of clear glass, whereas the light is bit dim through a paper. Light does not pass through metal sheet. Depending upon permeability, materials can be classified into three categories.

Transparent Material:

Materials that allow light to pass through completely are known as transparent material.

Example: Eye glasses, clear drinking glass, clear water, face glasses used in buses.

Translucent Material:

Objects that allow light to pass through partially are called translucent material. For

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